Findings: Where Things Stand

> Part of the Functional Series. This section draws conclusions from the platform's data and the comparisons made in the earlier sections. It adds no new analysis: every finding points to the table that supports it, and states what it does *not* say. Read the caveats before quoting any of it.
>
> **As of:** platform data to 2024 (emissions) and 2025 (concentration, temperature); references as dated in Benchmarks and Paris Agreement.

How each finding is written

Part	Meaning
Finding	A bounded statement of what the data show
Evidence	Where in this series the support is
Confidence	High, moderate or low, with the reason
Does not say	The over-reading to avoid

Finding 1. Global emissions have not yet started to fall

Finding. Fossil CO_2 was higher in 2024 than in 2019, the starting point of the IPCC pathways: **+4.1%** on fossil CO_2 and **+2.9%** including land use. It grew about **1% to 1.3%** in 2024 across the sources that exclude land use.

Evidence. Pathways §2 (observed 2024 against 2019); Emissions §3 (2024 growth across five sources).

Confidence. High for direction. The sources agree on the sign and, once land use is set aside, on the size within a few tenths of a percent. The platform's total greenhouse gas figure (50.6 $GtCO_2e$) is lower than UNEP's (57.7) by scope, not by disagreement about the trend.

Does not say. That emissions will not peak soon. The platform has no view on policy, and UNEP's policy-based studies project China's emissions peaking around 2025.

Finding 2. Atmospheric CO_2 keeps rising at a steady pace

Finding. Global-mean CO_2 was **425.6 ppm in 2025**, up from 410.1 in 2019: about **2.6 ppm a year**. The platform's Mauna Loa series, which runs about 1.7 ppm above the global mean, reads 427.4.

Evidence. Concentration §4.

Confidence. Very high: direct measurement, and independent global means agree to within 0.05 ppm.

Does not say. Anything about the rate in future years, which depends on emissions and on how well land and ocean sinks keep absorbing CO_2.

Finding 3. The planet is about 1.4 °C warmer than pre-industrial, and the recent years are above 1.5 °C

Finding. The long-term (underlying) warming level is about **1.4 °C** (Copernicus; Berkeley Earth; Forster et al.'s human-induced 1.37 °C). The platform's data give **1.45 °C for 2025 and 1.55 °C for 2024**, and **1.49 °C for the three years 2023–2025**, against single-year spreads of about 0.1 °C between datasets.

Evidence. Temperature §1–3.

Confidence. High that warming is about 1.3–1.4 °C and rising roughly 0.27 °C a decade (Forster et al.). Moderate for any single year: the platform's temperature series is preliminary, and individual years vary by about ±0.25 °C through natural variability.

Does not say. That the Paris 1.5 °C limit has been breached. The goal concerns the long-term level, which the IPCC reports as a 20-year average. Several sources estimate the underlying level will reach 1.5 °C around 2030 or in the early-to-mid 2030s.

Finding 4. Cumulative emissions track warming closely, as the IPCC says they should

Finding. Across 1850–2024 the platform finds **0.485 °C of warming per 1,000 $GtCO_2$** (95% interval 0.441–0.529, R^2 0.89), inside the IPCC's *likely* range of 0.27–0.63. Cumulative emissions to 2019 (2,542 $GtCO_2$) sit within the IPCC's estimate of 2,400 ± 240.

Evidence. Relationship §2–4; Emissions §4.

Confidence. Moderate. The agreement with the IPCC is encouraging, but the platform's figure is an analogue that also absorbs non-CO_2 warming, uses one climate history, and drifts upward when only recent decades are fitted (0.63 for 1970–2024).

Does not say. That emissions *caused* the warming on the strength of this regression alone (the platform labels it "context, not proof"), or that any country is responsible for a share of the warming.

Summary

#	Finding	Confidence
1	Global emissions are still above their 2019 level	High
2	CO_2 concentration rises about 2.6 ppm a year	Very high
3	Long-term warming is about 1.4 °C; the last three years averaged above 1.5 °C	High (trend); moderate (single years)

#	Finding	Confidence
4	Warming per unit of cumulative CO_2 is consistent with the IPCC range	Moderate

See also

- Trajectory Against Paris
- Country Differences
- Caveats and Reading Guide